

| AUTO |

IN WITH THE REAL

With the roll-out of Phase II of the BS VI norms soon, automakers are looking at another round of price hikes

BY PRERNA LIDHOO

► **THE FACE OF** the auto industry changed when the BS VI norms first kicked in, in April 2020. As the industry upgraded to the stricter emission norms, consumers saw a steep rise in prices across segments. The second phase of the norms, called real driving emission (RDE), are all set to come into effect from April 1, 2023. It will require all new vehicles to meet the emission targets as per the modified Indian drive cycle standards in real-world conditions and in a laboratory environment. A segment of the auto industry that will be particularly affected is carmakers as they will have to upgrade their engines, and that will entail additional costs. As a result, many of them are mulling to discontinue certain models.

Experts say that diesel vehicles will be impacted the most as they will have to shift to the more expensive SCR (selective catalytic reduction) method of emissions control, instead of the simpler and more cost-effective LNT (lean NOx trap) system currently in use.

“To quantify the full effect of the new norms at this point is slightly complicated. Definitely, it will require some additional



20 | ► **THE GOVERNMENT'S MOVE** to regulate e-sports and place higher due diligence requirements on online gaming companies is a shot in the arm for the sunrise sector as clear rules are expected to spur more entrants, boost investor confidence and create new jobs.

Recently, the Indian government recognised e-sports as part of mainstream sports and made the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) the nodal agency for all online gaming-related matters. In the first week of January, MeitY released draft amendments to the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021, to regulate the industry that has revenues of \$1.2 billion, per Invest India—the national investment promotion and facilitation agency.

The proposals legalise the status of the online gaming industry, spell out regulatory compliance requirements and streamline governance processes. MeitY has invited comments till the middle of the month. “While there has already been a steady growth of investor interest within the online gaming industry,

| GAMING |

Play by the Rules

The proposed rules for the online gaming industry will likely spur more entrants, boost investor confidence and create new jobs in the sunrise sector

BY VIDYA S.

